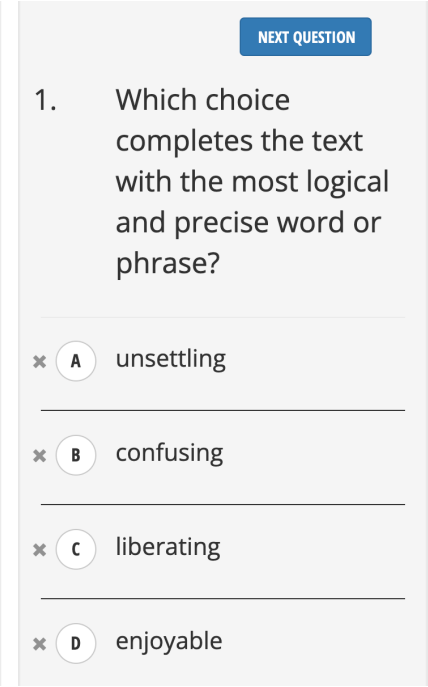
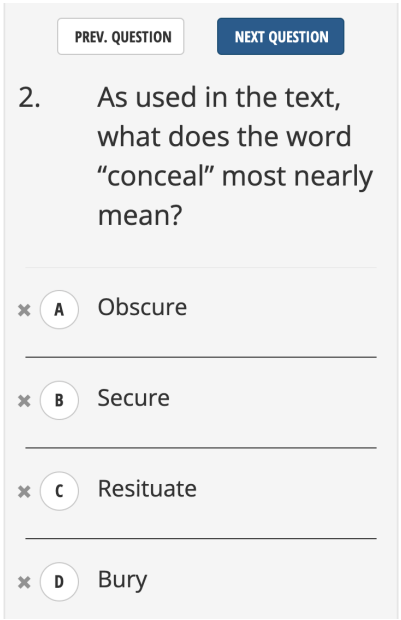
INNOVATOR TEST 2
READING AND WRITING MODULE 1

The "uncanny valley" is the name for a phenomenon that is prominent in science fiction films and that is often _____ for spectators: the surreal appearance of partially but not completely human-like figures, such as zombies and humanoid extraterrestrials, causes viewers to react with emotions ranging from nervous laughter to outright revulsion.



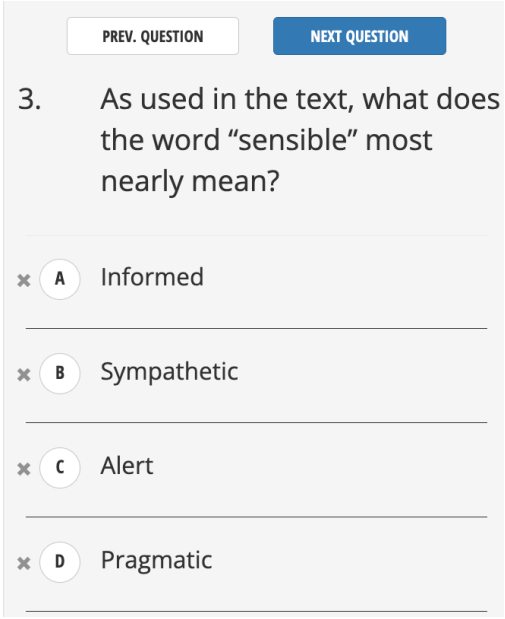
The following text is from James Fenimore Cooper's 1824 novel *The Pilot*.

> The cliffs threw their dark shadows wide on the waters, and the gloom of the evening had so far advanced as to conceal the discontent that brooded over the ordinarily open brow of Barnstable as he sprang from the rocks into the boat, and took his seat by the side of the silent pilot. "Shove off," cried the lieutenant, in tones that his men knew must be obeyed.



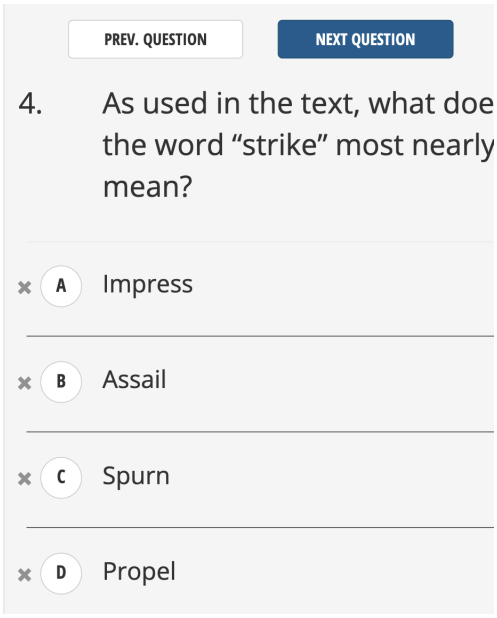
The following text is from Ricard Harding Davis's 1905 play *Miss Civilization*. Hatch, a burglar, is trying to defend his life of crime.

> HATCH: Stupid? Why, I make a living at it.
> ALICE: How much of a living?
> HATCH: Ten thousand a year.
> ALICE: Ten thousand—well, suppose you made FIFTY thousand. What good is even a hundred thousand for ONE year, if to get it you risk going to prison for twenty years? That's not sensible. Merely as a business proposition, to take the risk you do for ten thousand dollars is stupid isn't it?



The following text is from Angelina Weld Grimké's 1916 text *Rachel: A Play in Three Acts*.

> RACHEL: It's quite a climb up to our flat, don't you think?
> STRONG: Why, no! It didn't strike me so. I'm not old enough yet to mind stairs.
> RACHEL (Nervously): Oh! I didn't mean that you are old! Anyone can see you are quite young, that is, of course, not too young, but—(Strong laughs quietly). There! I don't blame you for laughing. I'm always clumsy just like that.



Originating from the Kamakura period of 1192 to 1333 CE, the Japanese tea ceremony serves as a _____ the bustle of daily life; the traditional space of the ceremony, a detached wooden house known as a *chashitsu*, facilitates calm appreciation for the refreshments and serving wares central to Japanese practice.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

5. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

× A symbol of

× B compromise with

× C retreat from

× D surrender to

The following text is from Charles Brockden Brown's 1798 novel *Wieland; or the Transformation*. In this passage, the narrator describes his father's early years as an apprentice to a London merchant.

My father was not fortunate in the character of him under whose care he was now placed. He was treated with rigor, and full employment was provided for every hour of his time. His duties were laborious and mechanical. He had been educated with a view to this profession, and, therefore, was not tormented with unsatisfied desires. He did not hold his present occupations in abhorrence, because they withheld him from paths more flowery and more smooth, but he found in unintermitted labour, and in the sternness of his master, sufficient occasions for discontent.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

6. Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

× A It provides a generality that is held up to questioning.

× B It mentions a goal that is further explained.

× C It calls attention to an ambition that proves unrealistic.

× D It surveys a situation that is elaborated upon.

The following text is from Frances E.W. Harper's 1888 novel *Trial and Triumph*.

In her white apron, faultless neck handkerchief and nicely fitting, but plain dress, Mrs. Harcourt looked the impersonation of contented happiness. Sorrow had left deep furrows upon her kindly face, but for a while the shadows seemed to have been lifted from her life and she was the pleasant hostess, forgetting her own sorrows in contributing to the enjoyment of others.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

7. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

× A Mrs. Harcourt has permanently forgotten her earlier problems.

× B Mrs. Harcourt's companions are troubled by past events.

× C Mrs. Harcourt is an appealing hostess despite her sad life.

× D Mrs. Harcourt's worries are making her antisocial.

Giant anteaters are neotropical mammals that, as their name suggests, consume ants, termites, and grubs, though they do occasionally eat fruit. Their habitat ranges from Central to South America in swamps, forests, and grasslands, where their favored prey is common. The solitary foragers have specialized tongues so they can consume thousands of ants in a few minutes after breaking open a nest, and they quickly abandon the site when soldier ants emerge to protect the colony.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

8. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

× A Giant anteaters live alone in neotropical areas that have not been disturbed by humans.

× B There are fewer opportunities for giant anteaters to eat since soldier ants are more vigilant.

× C Giant anteaters have adapted so that they are able to gather sufficient food.

× D Despite the danger of soldier ants, giant anteaters prefer to eat ants over other food sources.

The following text is adapted from Herman Melville's 1853 short story "Bartleby, The Scrivener." Here, the narrator is a lawyer who employs a few clerks, including Bartleby.

I abruptly called to Bartleby. In my haste and natural expectancy of instant compliance, I sat with my head bent over the original on my desk, and my right hand sideways, and somewhat nervously extended with the copy, so that, immediately upon emerging from his retreat, Bartleby might snatch it and proceed to business without the least delay.

In this very attitude did I sit when I called to him, rapidly stating what it was I wanted him to do—namely, to examine a small paper with me. Imagine my surprise, nay, my consternation, when, without moving from his privacy, Bartleby, in a singularly mild, firm voice, replied, "I would prefer not to."

I sat awhile in perfect silence, rallying my stunned faculties.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

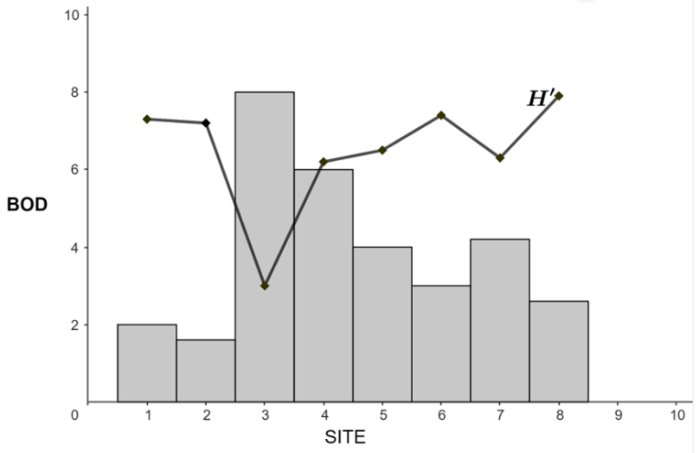
9. Based on the text, how does Bartleby respond to the narrator's request to examine the paper?

× A He rejects the narrator's idea, even though the narrator himself feels a bond with Bartleby.

× B He denies that he has heard the narrator, even though the narrator has endeavored to communicate clearly.

× C He expresses himself assertively, even though the narrator is expecting quick compliance.

× D He construes the request as difficult to fulfill, even though the narrator sees the request as straightforward.



Power plants use natural water sources in their operation. Assessing the algal makeup of the waters near a power plant is a useful method of determining water quality. H' is a count of algal species diversity in the water; thus, a high H' value indicates a healthy aqueous ecosystem. BOD (biological oxygen demand) indicates the amount of cellular respiration occurring in the water sample. Lower diversity causes runaway algal populations and, therefore, high BOD. Samples were taken from 8 areas near a power plant. Samples 1 and 2 were taken from the reservoirs (pre power plant usage) and samples 3–8 were measures of the effluent (post usage) as it continued downstream, with 3 being the area closest to the power plant. The researchers concluded that, as the effluent moved further from the powerplant, the water quality continued to improve.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

10. Which choice best describes data from the graph that weaken the researchers' conclusion?

× A The BOD at Site 1 was higher than the BOD at Site 2, although the H' value remained constant.

× B When H' dropped at Site 3, the BOD value rose.

× C The BOD value at Site 7 was higher than the BOD value at Site 6, and the H' value was lower.

× D The H' value at Site 1 was lower than the H' value at Site 8.

About 3 billion years ago, Earth was filled with microbial life capable of photosynthesis and producing oxygen. However, for hundreds of millions of years, oxygen did not accumulate in the atmosphere. According to Shintaro Kadoya, lead researcher on a study of early Earth at the University of Washington, the Earth's mantle held the key to this mystery. This period of time was an era of high volcanic activity, and the Earth's mantle is the source of molten rock and volcanic gases. Studying ancient volcanic rocks, Kadoya discovered that, until about 2.4 billion years ago, volcanoes spewed gases like hydrogen and nitrogen, which combine easily with oxygen. Kadoya hypothesized that the volcanic gases effectively removed almost all the oxygen from the atmosphere.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

11. Which finding, if true, would most directly support Kadoya's theory?

× A Volcanic rocks from 2 billion years ago indicate a higher level of nitrogen in the mantle than those from 3 billion years ago.

× B Volcanic rocks from 2.8 billion years ago show almost no traces of nitrogen or hydrogen.

× C Geological samples show that Earth's atmosphere contained high levels of hydrogen and nitrogen gases, in addition to high levels of oxygen, 2.2 billion years ago.

× D Geological samples show that Earth's atmosphere contained lower amounts of hydrogen and nitrogen gases, in addition to some oxygen, at around 2.3 billion years ago.

"Beachy Head" was written by Charlotte Turner Smith in the early years of the 1800s. In this poem, a narrator evokes a seaside landscape that settles into a sense of peacefulness: _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

12. Which quotation from "Beachy Head" best supports this claim?

✖ A "On thy stupendous summit, rock sublime! / That o'er the channel reared, half way at sea / The mariner at early morning hails, / I would recline"

✖ B "From thy projecting head-land I would mark / Far in the east the shades of night disperse, / Melting and thinned"

✖ C "From the dark blue wave / Emerging, brilliant rays of arrowy light / Dart from the horizon; when the glorious sun / Just lifts above it his resplendent orb."

✖ D "The high meridian of the day is past, / And Ocean now, reflecting the calm Heaven, /
Is of cerulean hue"

When companies begin marketing to a global audience, sometimes their message can get lost in translation. Cultural nuance can often be overlooked, resulting in awkward communication or offending potential customers. A classic case in point: in the 1920s, when Coca Cola first launched their product in China, they used Chinese characters that sounded like their English phonetic pronunciation. However, these characters ended up translating to "bite the wax tadpole," confounding their intended audience. Such a blunder highlights the importance of _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

13. Which choice most logically completes the text?

× A only targeting the audience that speaks one's native language.

× B researching the market before investing in advertising.

× C using humor to connect with the target audience.

× D avoiding all cultural references in advertisements.

A recent study explored the connection between emotions and charitable giving. Researchers partnered with a small college during a fundraising drive, in which 200 alumni were solicited by phone to make a donation to the college. 100 alumni were randomly selected to receive the standard phone pitch; for the other group, the fundraisers first asked the alumni to reflect on "a person or event in their past that had particularly benefited them since graduating." The results were dramatic: in the second group, donated amounts were 92% greater than the amounts contributed by the control group. The researchers theorize that people, when solicited for contributions, often first worry about their budget restrictions, but the new prompt subtly changed the donor's emotional state. Based on these results, when asking for donations, charities should _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

14. Which choice most logically completes the text?

× A advise possible donors to think about the impact their contributions could have.

× B contact the prospective donors by phone—instead of by mail or email—so their emotional state can be determined.

× C be aware of whether or not the would-be donor is wealthy before contacting that donor.

× D have the potential donor contemplate something positive before asking for a donation.

In a recent study on the effects of _____ found that regular coffee drinkers (those who consumed two or more cups per day) had a lower risk of developing Alzheimer's disease, compared to those who drank little to no coffee.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

15. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A caffeine researchers
- B caffeine; researchers
- C caffeine, researchers
- D caffeine. Researchers

COME BACK LATER

Northern New Zealand is home to some of the oldest forests on Earth. Forests filled with kauri, the Maori name for the *Agathis australis* tree, _____ back to the Jurassic Period over 135 million years ago.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

16. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A date
- B dating
- C they date
- D those forests date

Indian economist Radhakamal Mukerjee advocated for Asian communalism as the economic model for India _____ to traditional Indian villages where communities shared resources like water and pasture and worked together on large projects, Mukerjee argued that this approach, grounded in Asian values, was more appropriate for the country than the individualism and materialism that marked European economic theory.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

17. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A post-independence. Pointing

× B post-independence pointing

× C post-independence, pointing,

× D post-independence? Pointing

Wheat and rice are the most common cereal crops in the world and are consumed as the staple part of diets in many countries, but there are many other cereal _____ that can be eaten directly or fed to livestock.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

18. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A crops—such as rye and sorghum—

× B crops, such as rye, and sorghum,

× C crops—such as rye and sorghum,

× D crops, such as rye and sorghum—

Inflation occurs when the prices of goods and services increase, resulting in a decrease in the purchasing power of money. Economists debate about the effects of low levels of _____ high levels of inflation are universally accepted as disruptive to an economy.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

19. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A inflation,

× B inflation;

× C inflation:

× D inflation

In the globalized media landscape, creating a successful television show requires understanding a complex array of cultural, linguistic, and regional differences. Accordingly, a television producer must consider a _____ tastes when creating a show for international distribution.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

20. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A region's residents

× B region's residents'

× C regions' resident's

× D regions' residents

Bamboo, a widely distributed and fast-growing plant species, has several unique characteristics. Like _____ evolutionary ancestors, modern bamboo uses energy from an existing cane to produce more shoots and expand root structures.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

21. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A their
- B they're
- C its
- D it's

Inflated gas prices can trigger a ripple effect that extends beyond travel plans. As prices climb, employees reconsider how far they must drive to get to work. _____, remote opportunities become more attractive.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

22. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A Consequently,
- B Second,
- C However,
- D Nevertheless,

Viewing objects through the atmosphere is similar to peering through a stained glass window. Both the glass and the atmosphere have imperfections that alter the appearance of what we see. Unlike the static flaws in the glass, however, the imperfections in the atmosphere are in constant motion, causing further blurring. Moreover, the atmosphere filters and modifies the colors of objects viewed from the Earth. _____ a telescope above the atmosphere provides a far more accurate depiction of objects in space.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

23. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A Nevertheless,
- B For these reasons,
- C On the contrary,
- D In light of these advantages,

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- In 2022, the design firm Oceanix revealed a plan for a floating city district in Busan, South Korea.
- The project is known as Oceanix Busan and is meant to be highly adaptable.
- The Oceanix district is made of floating modules that can be built up over time.
- In its initial form, Oceanix Busan is meant to house up to 10,000 people.
- In its final form, Oceanix Busan could house up to 100,000 people.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

24. The student wants to emphasize that the Oceanix Busan project is meant to be highly adaptable. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

× A The floating city project known as Oceanix Busan was conceptualized by the design firm Oceanix.

× B Busan, a South Korean city, has been designated as the location for the Oceanix floating city.

× C Composed of flexible-format modules, Oceanix Busan could eventually house between 10,000 and 100,000 people.

× D The maximum number of people who could one day live in Oceanix Busan is roughly 100,000 residents.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Biologist Jessica Kendall-Barr investigated the sleep cycles of elephant seals.
- As part of a study begun in 2017, Kendall-Barr used a device known as an electroencephalogram (EEG) to monitor the brain activity of the seals.
- One set of EEG readings revealed that the seals sleep for roughly two hours per day when at sea.
- Another set of EEG readings revealed that the seals sleep for roughly ten hours per day when on land.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

25. The student wants to outline Kendall-Barr's findings on elephant seal sleep patterns. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

✖ A In a 2017 study, Kendall-Barr monitored elephant seals both at sea and on land.

✖ B Kendall-Barr determined that elephant seals sleep for approximately two hours when water-bound and ten hours when land-bound.

✖ C To study elephant seal sleep patterns, Kendall-Barr used an electroencephalogram (EEG) device.

✖ D EEG readings reveal brain activity and can be useful in tracking sleep patterns.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Freshwater tropical fish can tolerate temperatures from 18 to 26 degrees Celsius and may require a heater in the winter.
- Freshwater tropical fish are often kept in tanks with water plants, but since most eat vegetables as well as meat, these fish may consume the plants.
- Because ocean water temperatures remain relatively constant throughout the year, saltwater tropical fish must be monitored in a system with less than 2 degrees of variation.
- Saltwater tanks are usually maintained at the proper balance of minerals using synthetic salt.
- Most tropical saltwater aquarium fish are omnivores or scavengers.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

26. The student wants to explain a key difference between the care of tropical saltwater and freshwater fish. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

× A Tropical fish, whether freshwater or saltwater, most commonly eat meat, though some include vegetables in their diets.

× B Freshwater fish need to be kept in tanks with plants, though saltwater fish do not.

× C The acceptable temperature variations in a tank containing saltwater fish are much lower than what is acceptable for a tank containing freshwater fish.

× D Tanks containing freshwater tropical fish often have plants, but saltwater tropical fish need synthetic salt.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Maya Angelou was a famous civil rights activist, poet, and author, though she held many other roles throughout her life.
- *I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings* (1969) is one of her most acclaimed books; it publicly reveals details about her private life up to the age of 17.
- She was asked to read the poem "On the Pulse of Morning" at President Bill Clinton's inaugural ceremony in 1993.
- She directed her first movie, *Down the Delta*, in 1996.
- Published in 2013 when she was 85 years old, *Mom & Me & Mom* recounts her complex relationship with her own mother.
- At her death in 2014, she was working on a new book about her experiences with different world leaders.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

27. The student wants to emphasize an underlying theme in some of Maya Angelou's books. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

✖ A Maya Angelou wrote a wide variety of works in her later years, including *Down the Delta* and *Mom & Me & Mom*.

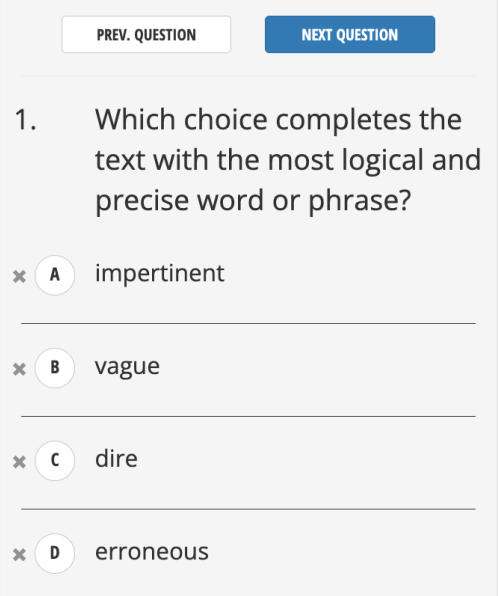
✖ B Many of Maya Angelou's works, such as *I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings* and *Mom & Me & Mom*, are autobiographical.

✖ C Maya Angelou had close contact with many world leaders, as shown by reading "On the Pulse of Morning" at President Bill Clinton's 1993 inaugural ceremony and writing a book on the subject prior to her death.

✖ D While some of her books received great critical acclaim, such as *I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings*, others were not popular, such as *Mom & Me & Mom*.

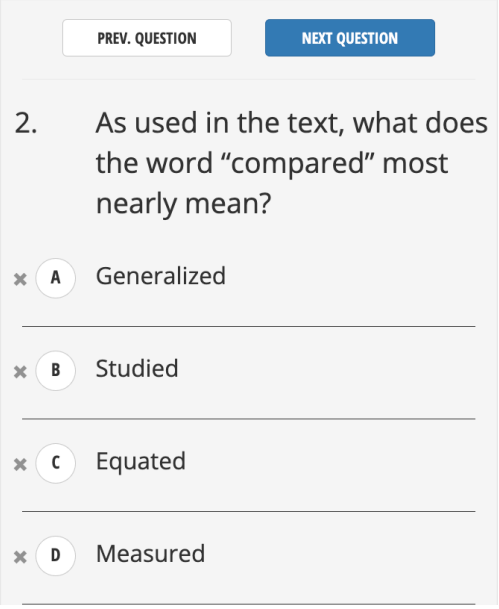
INNOVATOR TEST 2
READING AND WRITING MODULE 2B (HARDER)

Economist Irving Fisher made some of the most _____ predictions in US history. Days before the Stock Market Crash of 1929, Fisher forecasted perpetually high stock prices. Afterward, he claimed that the stock decline from the crash was only temporary and that prices would rebound in a few months. The market, however, fully recovered about twenty-five years later, in 1954.



The following text is from Nikolai Gogol's 1836 play *The Government Inspector*. Khlestakov has just arrived at Anna's hometown in the Russian countryside and is recounting his travels.

ANNA: You do me much honor. I don't deserve it.
KHLESTAKOV: Why don't you deserve it? You do deserve it, madam.
ANNA: I live in a village.
KHLESTAKOV: Well, after all, a village too has something. It has its hills and brooks. Of course it's not to be compared with St. Petersburg. Ah, St. Petersburg! What a life, to be sure! Maybe you think I am only a copying clerk. No, I am on a friendly footing with the chief of our department.



The following text is from Charles Dickens's novel *Oliver Twist*, published serially from 1837 to 1839.

> The donkey was in a state of profound abstraction: wondering, probably, whether he was destined to be regaled with a cabbage-stalk or two when he had disposed of the two sacks of soot with which the little cart was laden; so, without noticing the word of command, he jogged onward.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

3. As used in the text, what does the word "abstraction" most nearly mean?

- A. Generalization
- B. Hypothesis
- C. Intention
- D. Preoccupation

One obstacle to developing effective conservation tactics is the dearth of information about some at-risk species. Fortunately, it is possible to _____ the behavior of less studied animals, using data collected on those that have been studied in depth. Elise Zipkin of Michigan State University has been leading efforts of just this sort, evaluating the risks to "data-poor" animal populations by analyzing their "data-rich" counterparts.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

4. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A. extrapolate
- B. ameliorate
- C. bolster
- D. nullify

The following text is from Katherine Mansfield's 1921 short story "An Ideal Family."

> Harold was too handsome, too handsome by far; that had been the trouble all along. No man had a right to such eyes, such lashes, and such lips; it was uncanny. As for his mother, his sisters, and the servants, it was not too much to say they made a young god of him; they worshipped Harold, they forgave him everything; and he had needed some forgiving ever since the time when he was thirteen and he had stolen his mother's purse, taken the money, and hidden the purse in the cook's bedroom.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

5. Which choice best describes the function of the underlined portion in the text as a whole?

× A It anticipates the reactions detailed in the remainder of the sentence.

× B It disregards the tragedy explained in the previous sentence.

× C It builds on the previous sentence with an allusion to a character's education.

× D It leads into the remaining portions of the sentence by praising a setting.

The following text is from Sinclair Lewis's 1917 novel *The Job*.

Una, the initiate New Yorker, continued her study of city ways and city currents during her lunch-hours.
She went down to Broad Street to see the curb market; marveled at the men with telephones in little coops behind opened windows; stared at the great newspaper offices on Park Row, the old City Hall, the mingling on lower Broadway of sky-challenging buildings with the history of the pre-Revolutionary days.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

6. Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

✖ A It situates a character in a scene that interests her mainly from a historical perspective.

✖ B It indicates the emotional distance between a character and the people around her.

✖ C It defines a character and her surroundings in anticipation of the descriptions that follow.

✖ D It emphasizes the sociable yet thoughtful personality of a single character.

The following text is from Agatha Christie's 1920 novel *The Mysterious Affair at Styles*.

> I turned to Lawrence, to suggest that I had better leave them now that there was no further need of my services, but the words were frozen on my lips. Never have I seen such a ghastly look on any man's face. He was white as chalk, the candle he held in his shaking hand was sputtering onto the carpet, and his eyes, petrified with terror, or some such kindred emotion, stared fixedly over my head at a point on the further wall. It was as though he had seen something that turned him to stone.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

7. Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

✖ A To imply that the subsequent statements feature unreliable descriptions

✖ B To suggest a reason for the narrator's reaction in the previous sentence

✖ C To reiterate a point of uncertainty in the narrator's preceding statements

✖ D To highlight an exaggeration that is further investigated in the next sentence

Text 1

No connection has ever been shown between the Basque language and any other currently spoken language: it is considered an orphan language. But the theory that Basque might be related to other languages, in particular Georgian and other languages of the Caucasus, has interested scholars. In 1925, linguist Alberto Trombetti compiled supposed Caucasian-Basque cognates (words based on the same root). There are grammatical similarities between the two languages as well: both use an ergative case system, in which noun endings identify the sentence's subject.

Text 2

Since the search for a Caucasian-Basque link involves forty Caucasian languages, says linguist R.L. Trask, it's not surprising that resemblances can be found by chance. Although the presence of unusual grammar and common cognates has persuaded some linguists that there is a connection, Trask says this is simplistic. Similarities can occur without the languages having any common roots.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

8. Based on the texts, how would Trask (Text 2) likely characterize the theory presented in Text 1?

× A As intriguing, because there are not only common cognates but also common grammatical rules.

× B As persuasive, because the large number of Caucasian languages increases the likelihood of a connection to Basque.

× C As unfounded, because such commonalities can arise from coincidence.

× D As speculative, because several other languages use an ergative case system.

The following text is from Charles Dickens's 1853 novel *Bleak House*. Sir Leicester Dedlock and his wife are traveling by carriage.

Sir Leicester is generally in a complacent state, and rarely bored. When he has nothing else to do, he can always contemplate his own greatness. It is a considerable advantage to a man to have so inexhaustible a subject. After reading his letters, he leans back in his corner of the carriage and generally reviews his importance to society.

"You have an unusual amount of correspondence this morning?" says [Lady Dedlock] after a long time. She is fatigued with reading. Has almost read a page in twenty miles.

"Nothing in it, though. Nothing whatever."

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

9. Based on the text, how does Sir Leicester respond to Lady Dedlock's question about his correspondence?

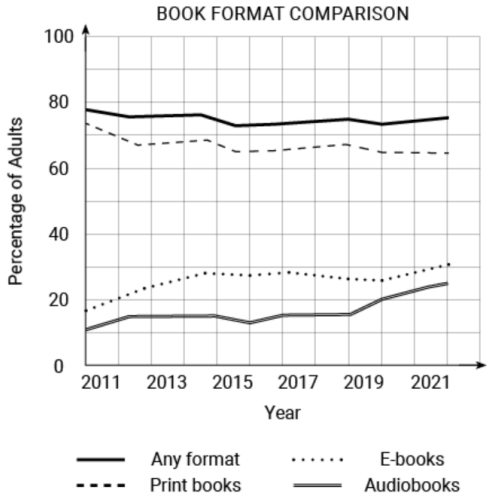
× A He asserts that he has examined his letters attentively, even though he has made little progress reading them.

× B He suggests that his letters are trifling, even though he is firmly convinced of his significance.

× C He appears to neglect his wife's inquiry, even though he is interested in her opinion.

× D He attempts to summarize the news he has received, even though he does not understand what he has read.

Reading Among US Adults



A major book retailer is investigating the popularity of audiobooks in comparison to traditional print books. In order to identify any trends, the retailer conducted a survey spanning ten years of customer data to gain insight into their reading habits. The survey results revealed a significant increase in customer preference

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

10. Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to illustrate the survey results?

× A the percentage of people who had listened to an audiobook more than doubled since 2011, growing from 11% to nearly 25%.

× B the percentage of people who had listened to an audiobook nearly doubled since 2011, growing from 17% to 30%.

× C since 2011, the percentage of people who had listened to an audiobook has increased to nearly a third of the total percentage of people who read a print book.

× D the percentage of people who had listened to an audiobook decreased for the initial 7 years, then increased substantially.

Over the past 30 years, scientists have discovered many dinosaurs from the *Carcharodontosauridae* family, but a lack of complete fossils led to many assumptions about their structure and movement. However, a recent find of a species named *Meraxes gigas* in Argentina gives new insights. Standing 11 meters (36 feet) and weighing 4 tons, this carnivore probably appeared very much like the unrelated *Tyrannosaurus rex*. This conclusion is partly based on the discovery of an almost intact arm bone that is extremely short, like those of *T. rex*.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

11. Which finding, if true, would most strongly support the scientists' conclusion?

✖ A *M. gigas* and *T. rex* were discovered to have lived in time periods separated by about 20 million years.

✖ B The skull bones from the *M. gigas* fossil are oversized in proportion to the body, as are those of *T. rex* fossils.

✖ C The average size of an adult *T. rex* varied greatly, between 5 tons and almost 7 tons.

✖ D Remains from both *T. rex* and *M. gigas* show that they both were carnivores that preyed on mostly herbivorous dinosaurs.

Venice, Italy, has been a renowned center for glass production since the eighth century. In 1291, a governmental decree relocated the city's glassmaking industry to the nearby island of Murano. The official rationale for this move was to eliminate the risk of fire in the city of Venice caused by the glass furnaces. However, several historians assert that the true motive behind this legislation was to isolate the glass craftsmen in a location where they could not disseminate trade secrets.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

12. Which statement, if true, would most strongly support the historians' claim?

✖ A A glassmakers' guild was established in Murano to protect trade secrets, and it was forbidden to contact foreign glassmakers.

✖ B Glass artisans were afforded a high social status, and their daughters were eligible to marry into the wealthiest social classes.

✖ C The Venetian government encouraged glass artisans to pass down their trade secrets to their children, thereby ensuring that such knowledge remained within the family.

✖ D In 1295, a subsequent law was enacted that prohibited glassmakers from leaving the city.

In the center of an elaborate piece of jewelry found in King Tutankhamun's tomb in Egypt is a piece of rare yellow glass that is only found in the Sahara Desert. It is known today as Libyan desert glass, and its origin has been the subject of debate. Geologist Aaron Cavosie of Curtin University explains that there are two possible causes: either a meteorite impact or an "airburst" (when a "near-earth object" burns up in earth's atmosphere). Both events can produce the high-temperature fusion required to create this type of glass. Studying the zircon grains in the glass, Dr. Cavosie confirmed that a rare mineral, reidite, must have been present for zircon crystals to form. Since reidite only could have been present if a meteorite generated shockwaves after hitting Earth, he concluded that a meteorite impact created Libyan desert glass.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

13. Which finding, if true, would most directly weaken the researcher's claim?

× A Identical zircon crystals have been found in other pieces of prehistoric glass around the world.

× B Evidence of reidite has been found near a known meteorite impact site.

× C Using ground-penetrating radar, researchers detected a large meteorite crater near the Sahara Desert.

× D Small amounts of reidite have been detected at an airburst site in Siberia.

A Tale of Two Cities is an 1859 novel by Charles Dickens. In the novel, Sydney Carton and Mr. Stryver are two lawyers who often collaborate, though Sydney fails to fully utilize his talents and affects an air of indifference: _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

14. Which quotation from *A Tale of Two Cities* most effectively illustrates the claim?

× A "Although Sydney Carton would never be a lion, he was an amazingly good jackal, and that he rendered suit and service to Stryver in that humble capacity."

× B "Sydney had been working double tides that night, and the night before, and the night before that, and a good many nights in succession, making a grand clearance among Mr. Stryver's papers before the setting in of the long vacation."

× C "When [Sydney] cared to talk, he talked well; but, the cloud of caring for nothing, which overshadowed him with such a fatal darkness, was very rarely pierced by the light within him."

× D "It was not a reckless manner, the manner in which [Sydney] said these words aloud under the fast-sailing clouds, nor was it more expressive of negligence than defiance. It was the settled manner of a tired man, who had wandered and struggled and got lost, but who at length struck into his road and saw its end."

Italian philosopher and writer Umberto Eco was known for his wide-ranging knowledge of language, medieval history, and Western civilization. When visitors entered his home, they were amazed to see a library containing over 30,000 books, many of which he had never even opened. Rather than viewing his vast assemblage of books as a testament to his wisdom, Eco saw it as a collection of the knowledge he still wished to acquire. To Eco, the principal task of his library was _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

15. Which choice most logically completes the text?

× A to store information he might someday need to know.

× B to accumulate learning that he desired but had not yet accessed.

× C to display both the books he had read and those that he had not.

× D to contain writings that he was unlikely to ever read.

In the field of biodiversity, the neutral model predicts that species variation would increase over time, as random events lead to different species becoming dominant in different areas. However, in one study, some sites became dominated by one species, and researchers have found that variance among the sites did not increase over the years, leading them to conclude that stabilizing forces were maintaining forest diversity. While these stabilizing forces are not entirely clear, the results from the study indicate that biodiversity has not been maintained in the past through a random process. Therefore, if a species were to become extinct _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

16. Which choice most logically completes the text?

× A the loss of that species would lead to an increase in diversity of the community.

× B the loss of that species would have no effect on the overall diversity of the community.

× C in one area, it would be guaranteed to be replaced by a similar species through random chance.

× D in one area, it may not necessarily be replaced by a similar species through random chance, but instead by the stabilizing forces.

When sunlight reaches the Earth's surface, the incoming solar _____ is composed of various wavelengths of light, affects the Earth in different ways. One type of radiation, infrared light, is absorbed by the ground, warming the planet and providing the energy necessary for life to thrive.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

17. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A radiation. Which

× B radiation which

× C radiation, which

× D radiation; which

The first modern American supermarket in the US opened in Memphis, Tennessee in 1916. Previously, grocery store customers would hand their shopping lists to a clerk who would gather the requested items from behind a counter. Named “Piggly Wiggly,” the Memphis store was the first to place items on _____ customers—instead of a clerk—choose and collect their purchases.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

18. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A shelves; letting

× B shelves and they let

× C shelves letting

× D shelves, letting

The brain of the sperm whale, which in males can reach up to 20 pounds, _____ to be the largest of any mammal. However, recent studies by the National Marine Mammal Foundation in San Diego, California, have established that brains of killer whales can also reach this size. The human brain, by contrast, weighs approximately 3 pounds.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

19. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A had long been considered

× B have long been considered

× C long considered

× D were long considered

The second-smallest country by area in the world after Vatican City, Monaco is a mere 2.1 square kilometers. Most famous for the Monte Carlo Casino, _____. In fact, Monaco is a pioneer in marine conservation, with one of the first protected marine areas in the world.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

20. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A there is also an oceanographic museum in the country that is world-class

× B the country is also home to a world-class oceanographic museum

× C a world-class oceanographic museum is also in the country

× D the country's world-class museum of oceanography resides just a few kilometers away.

The adoption of 3D printing technology in the field of medicine is having a significant impact. Replacement joints can be manufactured for a fraction of the previous cost and produced much more quickly. A prosthetic knee, for example, can now be made by a 3D printer for less than _____ thousands of dollars less than the cost of a traditionally manufactured knee of the same kind.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

21. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A $500, that is

× B $500; which is

× C $500—

× D $500;

In the 1930s, comedians Bud Abbott and Lou Costello combined their talents to create a tremendously successful comedy duo, Abbott and Costello. In fact, by the 1940s, the comedy team enjoyed worldwide fame. _____ most famous routine, "Who's on First," is considered to be one of the greatest comedy performances of all time.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

22. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A Abbott and Costello's

× B Abbott's and Costello's

× C Abbott and Costellos'

× D Abbotts' and Costellos'

Today's readers owe a debt of gratitude to the early printers whose efforts made reading materials increasingly available and thus furthered the spread of literacy and learning. _____ his innovative moveable type, Johannes Gutenberg is the best known of those printers, but there were many other printers in the 15th and 16th centuries who are still remembered today.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

23. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

× A Because of

× B Regardless of

× C In contrast to

× D In addition to

Dandelions are usually considered to be useless weeds. _____ they can be used in many recipes, as their leaves are edible and perfect for salads. Mature flowers are bitter, but young buds are sweet and taste slightly like honey.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

24. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

× A Otherwise,

× B Nevertheless,

× C Besides,

× D Moreover,

The practice known as biological control, or biocontrol, refers to the reduction of pest populations by natural enemies instead of by synthetic pesticides. Biocontrol has already found its way onto some golf courses; _____ a 2018 survey by the Environmental Institute for Golf found that 42 percent of larger golf facilities (27 holes or more) sometimes or frequently use biocontrol in their pest management practices.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

25. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

× A in other words,

× B indeed,

× C nonetheless,

× D however,

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- In 1713, ancient Roman coins were found bearing the name and image of "Emperor Sponsian."
- No record of a Roman leader named Sponsian exists, so, in the 19th century, the discovery was branded a forgery.
- In 2022, using microscopes to inspect the coins, scientist Paul Pearson and his team were able to see patterns typical of coins that were in circulation.
- The researchers also analyzed soil deposits on the coins, finding evidence that the coins were buried for centuries.
- The scientific evidence demonstrates that the Sponsian coins are genuine.
- Historians now theorize that Sponsian was the military leader of a minor Roman outpost in the 3rd century CE.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

26. The student wants to describe a misconception about the coins and how that misbelief was disproved. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

× A The Sponsian coins were subjected to modern scientific analysis, which revealed patterns of extensive usage and of a lengthy period underground.

× B Because there was no record anywhere of a Roman Emperor Sponsian, 19th century historians judged the Sponsian coins to be fakes, but 21st century scientists have concluded that they are real.

× C Though once considered to be counterfeit, today scientists consider the Sponsian coins to be genuine and Emperor Sponsian to have been a minor Roman military leader in the 3rd century CE.

× D Although originally labeled as fakes because no Roman leader named Sponsian existed in any historical record, scientific analysis of the coins' surfaces now indicates that the Sponsian coins are authentic.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Japanese porcelain art dates back to the 5th century CE
- Starting in the 1880s, two artists from Satsuma province created porcelain that was internationally celebrated.
- Makuzu Kozan developed a method in which he applied multiple underglaze colors to the pottery.
- Kozan experimented with glazing techniques, creating works that were both richly colored and seemingly transparent.
- Yabu Meizan's porcelains are known for their intricate decoration, applied using copper plates.
- A single piece by Meizan might depict thousands of flowers or hundreds of people.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

27. The student wants to describe the differences between the work of the two Japanese porcelain artists. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

✖ A While Makuzu Kozan's artistry was displayed in his glazes that yielded deep colors and a translucent appearance, Yabu Meizan's porcelain was notable for its complicated decoration with innumerable images.

✖ B Although they both lived in the same province, Satsuma, Japanese artists Makuzu Kozan and Yabu Meizan employed different methods to create their stunning porcelain works.

✖ C Japanese porcelain art, which began in the 5th century CE, was carried on into the late 19th century by two highly skilled, but different, artists: Makuzu Kozan and Yabu Meizan.

✖ D Japanese porcelain artist Makuzu Kozan experimented with multiple glazing techniques, creating rich colors and a translucent impression, but his contemporary, Yabu Meizan, took his porcelains in a completely different direction.